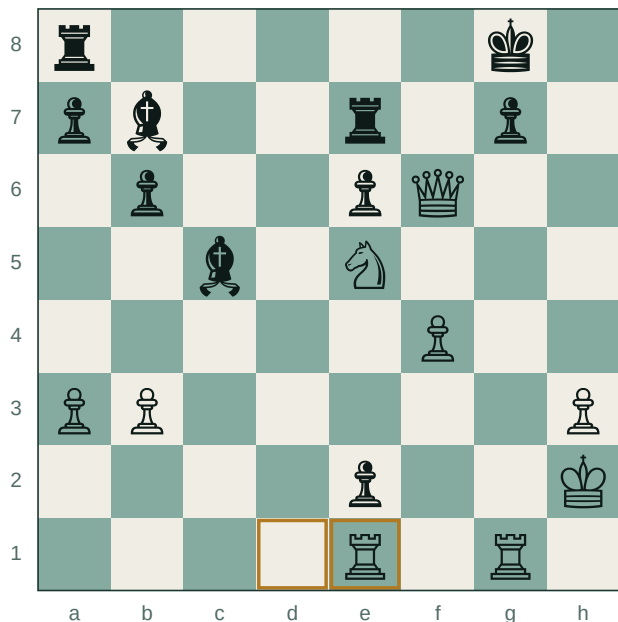


# Promotion combinations: Black, move 33

Promotion combinations

Black to move



Previous move: 33.Rde1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**33...Bxg1+ 34. Rxg1 e1=Q 35. Qxe6+ Rxe6**

**33...Bxg1+** Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on g1. Recorded reply: **34.Rxg1**.

**34...e1=Q** The pawn moves from e2 to e1. The pawn becomes a queen. From e1 it attacks rook on g1 and knight on e5. Recorded reply: **35.Qxe6+**.

**35...Rxe6** The rook captures the queen on e6.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 25 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +18. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +18:** the balance goes from -5 to +13. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Always inspect stalemate and underpromotion resources. A queen is usually strongest, but the exact position determines the choice.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

An advanced pawn can turn a tactical sequence into a new queen or another useful piece. Promotion may occur with capture or check, and the choice of piece can change the outcome.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Calculate the pawn's route, the safety of the promotion square, and whether the new piece can survive or give a decisive check.

The defending king is on h2. Geometrically undefended: queen on f6. Check for tactical protection.